

9000 chipset, paired with up to 16GB of RAM, which is good enough for a laptop as well, let alone a smartphone. Given the premium chipset from MediaTek and RAM overkill, there is no doubt that the OnePlus Nord 3 5G is a superb performer.

Of course, we ran a bunch of benchmarks on the OnePlus Nord 3 5G and the smartphone aced most of them. On AnTuTu, the OnePlus Nord 3 5G was able to put out a score of 905,530 points, which is one of the highest on this year's mid-range smartphones. On Geekbench also, the smartphone outperforms many mid-rangers from 2023, but has been outperformed by a few devices like the Vivo V27 Pro, Poco F5, Moto Edge 40, and the likes.

We also ran PCMark Work 3.0 benchmark on the OnePlus Nord 3 5G and here, the smartphone didn't put out as impressive numbers as compared to the other CPU-based benchmark tests.

In GPU-based tests also, the OnePlus Nord 3 5G didn't impress me as much as I expected the smartphone to, but the numbers are still very good for a smartphone at this level.

What the numbers show and how the OnePlus Nord 3 performs in real life are pretty much similar. During my daily usage, I never felt any kind of a lack of performance while using the smartphone, or even doing certain demanding tasks like playing games or photography, or even tasks like editing photos and videos on the smartphone.

The OnePlus Nord 3 5G uses the UFS 3.1 storage standard, which is not the latest, but a pretty fast storage standard. In storage-based testing, the smartphone showed similar read and write speeds as compared to its rivals, with a few minor differences here and there.

Overall, this is a pretty good performer. Yes, it's not the fastest or the highest-specced device in this range, but the OnePlus Nord 3 5G never leaves its users asking for more. Playing games on this smartphone is a beautiful experience, and the smartphone handles multitasking as well

as pretty much any other smartphone out there, not just a mid-ranger.

BATTERY

Here, we get a 5,000mAh battery on the OnePlus Nord 3 5G, which has sort of become the standard in most smartphones these days. The backup on this battery is quite good. I put the OnePlus Nord 3 5G on a video loop test, where I played a 4K video on the smartphone with high brightness until the battery drained out, and the smartphone lasted for a very impressive 733 minutes or 12.2 hours!

Now, while on video playback, the OnePlus Nord 3 puts out an impressive time of over 12 hours, that is not the case with all tasks. In my tests, I found the smartphone to be draining the battery a bit too fast while using GPS. I used the GPS navigation for one hour straight and the smartphone lost 9 percent of the battery. While playing a Call of Duty Mobile online session for 15 minutes, the smartphone lost 5 percent battery.

With a good battery backup, the OnePlus Nord 3 5G also offers super fast charging. The smartphone comes with 80W SuperVOOC fast charging, which I tested during my review. The smartphone only took 34 minutes to charge from 0 to 100 percent, which is super fast for any segment, not just the sub-₹35,000 price bracket.

CAMERA

The camera here is a triple camera setup. This includes a primary 50-megapixel Sony IMX890 shooter with OIS, an 8-megapixel wide angle lens, and a 2-megapixel macro shooter. The camera performance here is pretty decent. In well-lit environments, this camera is capable of putting out some brilliant images with pixel binning on. However, with the full 50-megapixel resolution or in high resolution mode, the OnePlus Nord 3 5G at times overexposes details.

In other conditions such as low light, the smartphone sometimes struggles, but mostly the results are

very much usable. The portraits on the smartphone, on the other hand, are brilliant. The OnePlus Nord 3 5G takes very nice portraits. The image is sharp and detailed, and the edge detection is almost spot-on. The dynamic range in portraits is also pretty good, even in average lighting conditions.

Like the portrait mode, the front camera of the OnePlus Nord 3 5G also impressed me quite a bit. Selfies on the OnePlus Nord 3 5G are sharp, vibrant and detailed. The smartphone has a 16-megapixel front shooter, which will keep all the selfie lovers out there pretty satisfied.

VERDICT

To conclude, the OnePlus Nord 3 5G is a complete mid-ranger. The performance is very good, the display is stunning, and surprisingly the camera is right up there with the competition. While the smartphone has a very nice in-hand feel, the way it looks is pretty much similar to the OnePlus Nord CE 3 5G and I am not a big fan of the two flash.

Yes, the performance is not the best in this segment, but it will never leave you asking for more with its 16GB RAM. I'm not a fan of the design, especially the two LED flash modules (or whatever the second circle is for), but there are plenty of people who have liked this design. Further, you get glass back and IP rating, so that's great. The battery sometimes drains while doing specific tasks like GPS or using the camera, but the super fast 80W charging makes up for it.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: MediaTek Dimensity 9000 | GPU: Mali-G710 MC10 | OS: OxygenOS 13.1 based on Android 13 | Display: 6.74-inch FHD+ Fluid AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 16GB | ROM: Up to 256GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 8MP + 2MP | Cameras (front): 16MP | Video: 4K @ 60fps | Battery: 5000mAh | Charging: 80W

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